Men and Events

An exhibition of modern Chinese paintings and drawings organized by "VOKS" will be opened in May in Moscow.

The inauguration of direct radio communication between China and Italy is scheduled to take place in August next.

R. H. Gregory, director of the British Cigarette Company, is ill at the Country Hospital where he was operated on this week.

The Hwa Yin Arsenal located in the outskirts of Sian is being converted into a factory for the manufacture of farm implements.

Nine sailors of the Chinese gunboat *Tungchi* were drowned April 22, as a result of the capsizing of a sampan on the Yangtsze River.

The French Consolate-General in Nanking April 27 categorically denied Japanese press reports that French troops have invaded Yunnan province.

The Ministry of Justice has transferred Dr. Ying Shih, president of the District Court in the French Concession, to Soochow, where will become President of the Soochow District Court.

Teng Kuei, F.R.SA., delivered a lecture entitled "Bamboo and Bamboo Painting" before the North China branch of the Royal Asiatic Society May 3. It was illustrated with lantern slides.

Dr. E. C. Carter, secretary-general of the Institute of Pacific Relations, arrived in Peiping April 25 from Shanghai by the through express accompanied by Mrs. Carter and Mr. Liu, secretary of the China Council of the Institute.

Dr. Wang Wen-hao, noted geologist who was recently injured in a motor car accident, left the Kwang Chi Hospital at Hangchow April 27. He later proceeded to Peiping to enter the Union Medical Hospital there for further treatment.

Japan is the title a new reference work which has just been published in Moscow purporting to impart information about Japanese economy, politics, history and culture. According to the Soviet press the new book manifests definite anti-Japanese tendencies.

The Mongolian and Tibetan Affairs Committee has decided to request the Nanking City Government to allot a piece of vacant land for the construction of offices for the Nanking representatives of the Mongolian, Tibetan and Mohammedan authorities.

No levy other than the Customs duty may be imposed on gasoline and petroleum, a dispatch from the Ministry of Finance to the Szechuan Provincial Government warned April 27. Reports had been received that an extra levy has been imposed in Chungking.

General Chiang Kai-shek has issued a circular order to the provinces to the effect that all Chinese citizens owe it as a duty to serve the country for three days each year in whatever work is assigned to them by the authorities. For this service the citizens are not to get any remuneration.

The American authorities in Shanghai have returned an official finding that Belle Grooch, wife of Willism S. Grooch, threw herself and two small sons off the roof of the Washington Apartments on January 19 while Mrs. Grooch was "temporarily insane," thus meeting instant death.

Robert Barnett, 22-year-old son of E. E. Barnett, personnel secretary of the Chinese National Committee of the Y.M.C.A., is expected to arrive in Shanghai early in June. He will spend about two months in China before continuing on around the world to England, where he will enter Oxford.

Dr. W. W. Yen, Chinese Minister to Soviet Russia, returned to Tientsin April 25 after a visit to Peiping. Dr. Yen announced that he will remain in Tientsin for a month, following which he will proceed to Nanking to seek instructions from the Government. He said he expected to return to his post in Moscow in June.

Dr. Wang Shih-chieh, Minister of Education, delivered a speech on the fundamental problems of education in China at the Provincial Party Headquarters in Hangchow April 24. Minister Wang placed special emphasis on the importance of centralized control over private schools, and the independence of educational funds.

Six kidnappers were taken from the First Special District Court in Shanghai April 30 to Tsaohokin for execution. The leader was sentenced to death on charges of having kidnapped one Wan Hai-sung in Kwangse Road near Swatow Road, at 7.45 p.m. on January 23. He embraced his wife and babies in court, with tears in his eyes.

Yotaro Sugimura, former Assistant Secretary-General of the League of Nations, who last autumn gained prominence by expounding the Japanese idea of dealing regionally with China, has been selected for the post of Japanese Ambassador to Rome, in succession to Hajime Matsushima, who recently informed the Foreign Ministry of his intentions to retire.

The United States Minister to China, Nelson T. Johnson, arrived in Nanking May 2 by steamer from Kiangsi, where he had an interview with General Chiang Kai-shek. In continuation of his tour of Yangtze ports, the Minister is due to arrive in Shanghai May 6 to meet Professor James Rogers, United States monetary expert.

Brigadier-General Fredric L. Bradman, who is making an inspection tour of U. S. Marine forces in the Far East, inspected the French troops here April 28. Later on the same day Gen. Bradman visited Mayor Wu Te-chen, of Greater Shanghai at the City Government. A guard of honor was lined up in front of the government building when the general arrived.

A set of regulations governing the despatch of Social-Letter Telegrams (SLT) has been promulgated by the Ministry of Communications. According to these regulations, SLT messages include New Year or Christmas greetings, birthday or condolence messages, wedding announcements, etc. Such messages must be marked with the abbreviation "SLT," which will be charged as one word.

The new one-million-dollar dry-dock of the Kiangnan Dockyard in Shanghai, which is nearing completion, will be inaugurated on June 1, according to Admiral Chen Shao-kwan, Naval Minister. The opening of the new dock will also mark the launching of the two new gunboats *Changning* and *Chengning* and the commissioning of the *Ining* and *Tsungning* into the river fleet.

According to Lo Wen-kan, Minister of Judicial Administration, it is impossible for the time being to carry out the Government's plan of sending convicts to the Northwest for reclamation purposes in view of financial difficulties and inconvenience in communications. The project, he added, will be carried out gradually as plans progress for the development of the Northwest.

The Debating Club of the Foreign Y.M.C.A. had before it at a meeting May 3 the subject, "Resolved, that the political salvation of the world lies in dictatorship rather than democracy." The "Y" club was represented by Messrs. H. C. Faulder and P. G. Sixsmith, while Messrs. Robert K. Burns and Lyle M. Spencer, Jr., two young men from the University of Washington, took the opposing side.

Complaints were received at both the Executive Yuan and the Ministry of Finance last week from villagers at Kwang Wha Petroleum Company's Gough Island, Pootung, against the large oil reservoir there. The villagers charged that the company has commandeered some 2,500 square feet of their land without paying any compensation. The Kwang Wha Petroleum Company is a Chinese firm dealing chiefly in Soviet oil.

Dr. H. H. Kung, Minister of Finance and concurrently vice-president of the Executive Yuan, departed from Nanking April 25 on board the customs cruiser *Haihsing* on a two-weeks inspection tour throughout the provinces of Kiangsi, Anhwei, Honan and Hupeh in the interest of financial matters, accompanied by his wife and Jabin Hsu, his secretary. Dr. Kung first visited General Chiang Kai-shek, at Kuling, for a conference.

Indictments charging one Frenchman and two Japanese with smuggling diamonds worth Yen 1,106,500 were returned by the examining magistrates office of the Tokyo District Court April 26. The men, N. Tecla, a Syrian with French papers, and Eizo Tsunotani and Toyoteru Minowa, are said to have confessed to having smuggled the diamonds into Japan during the past three years. The stones were obtained by Charles Chalhoub, also French, who has offices in Paris.

General Chen Yi, Chairman of the Fukien Provincial Government, has telegraphed to the Provisional Headquarters of the President of the Military Affairs Commission at Nanchang, urging the despatch of special deputies to Fukien to look after the salt problem. The Fukien chairman has taken this step, it is understood, as certain profiteers have been found supplying salt to the Reds, and as it has been reported that the price of salt, especially in northern Fukien, is being raised by dealers.

Milton J. Helmick's Appointment Confirmed

The appointment of Milton J. Helmick of Albuquerque, New Mexico, to be judge of the United States Court for China, was confirmed by the United States Senate April 25. Judge Helmick was formerly a Superior Court Judge for the State of New Mexico, and has been a leading figure in Democratic politics in New Mexico for many years.

The clerk of the U. S. Court, on receiving news of the confirmation of Mr. Helmick's appointment, sent a cable to Judge Helmick, asking for authorization to issue summonses in the latter's name. The date of the Judge Helimick's departure from the United States has so far not been announced.